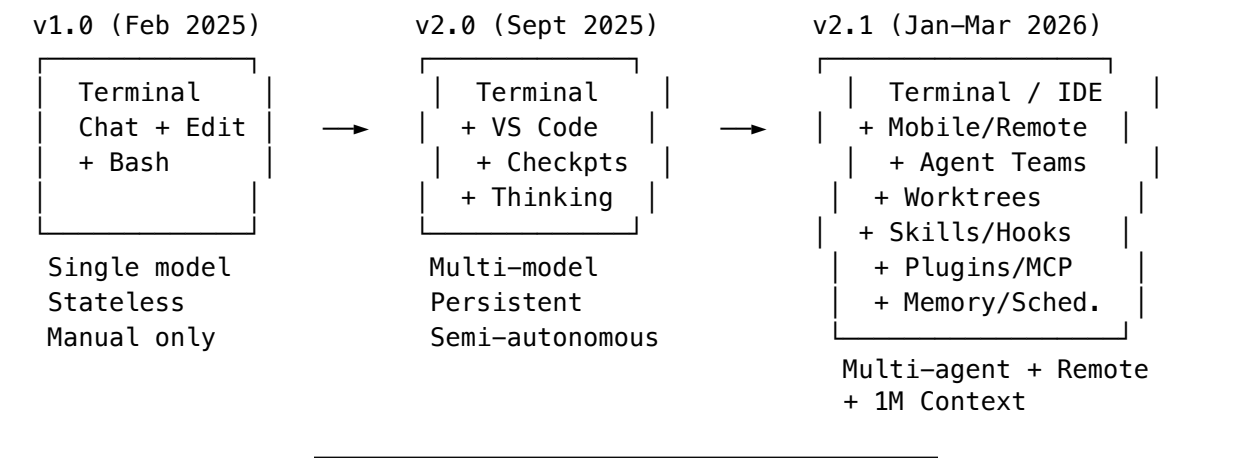


Claude Code: The Complete Evolution Timeline

v0.2 (2024) □ v2.1.76 (March 14, 2026)

From a simple terminal chatbot to a multi-agent development platform in 14 months.

Architecture Evolution



Phase 1: Initial Launch (February - September 2025)

v1.0.0 Preview (February 2025)

The first public release. A terminal-based AI coding assistant.

Feature	Description
Core CLI	Chat with Claude directly in terminal
File Editing	Edit files with natural language commands
Bash Integration	Run shell commands with permission prompts
Git Integration	Commit, diff, branch operations
Permission System	Allow/deny tool access per session
CLAUDE.md	Project-level instructions file
Session Persistence	Basic -c (continue) and -r (resume)

v1.0.0 GA (May 2025)

General availability alongside Claude Opus 4 and Claude Sonnet 4.

Feature	Description
Multi-Model Support	Choose between Opus, Sonnet, Haiku
Web Browsing	Fetch and analyze web content
Claude Agent SDK	Headless mode (-p flag) for scripting
Context Compaction	Auto-compress conversation when context fills

v1.0.x Series (March - September 2025)

Rapid feature additions through the first year.

Month	Features Added
March 2025	Vim/Emacs keybindings, custom commands (<code>.claude/commands/</code>), thinking mode, auto-compaction
April 2025	Image support, @-mentions, concurrent queries, network tools
May 2025	MCP server support (v1.0.52), plugin system (v1.0.33+)
Jun-Sept	Incremental improvements through v1.0.128

Phase 2: IDE & Autonomy (September - December 2025)

v2.0.0 (September 29, 2025) — Major Architectural Shift

Complete reimaging. Designed for autonomous, multi-hour sessions.

Feature	Description
VS Code Extension	Native IDE integration with sidebar, inline diffs
Checkpoint System	Automatic snapshots every prompt. <code>Esc Esc</code> to rewind. 30-day retention
Extended Thinking	Tab key toggles deep reasoning mode
Prompt History	<code>Ctrl+R</code> to search past prompts
Default Model	Claude Sonnet 4.5 (new at launch)
Subagents	Delegate subtasks to specialized agents (Explore, Plan)
Revamped Terminal	Better display for autonomous operations

v2.0.x Series (October - December 2025)

76 incremental releases stabilizing the new architecture.

Phase 3: Agent Framework (January 2026)

v2.1.0 (January 7, 2026) — 1,096 Commits

The skills and hooks overhaul.

Feature	Description
Skills System	<code>SKILL.md</code> with YAML frontmatter, hot-reload, forked context, custom agents
Hooks in Frontmatter	Skills and agents can define their own hooks
Shift+Enter	Newlines in prompts without configuration
/teleport	Move sessions to <code>claude.ai/code</code> (web)
MCP list_changed	Dynamic tool updates from MCP servers
Language Config	Configure Claude's response language
Wildcard Permissions	Bash <code>(*-h*)</code> pattern matching

v2.1.41-44 (January 2026)

Feature	Description
Auth Subcommands	<code>claude auth login/status/logout</code>
Session Naming	<code>/rename</code> command for sessions
Opus 4.6 Model	New model with effort levels
Windows ARM64	Native binary support

Phase 4: Multi-Agent & Remote (February 2026)

v2.1.45-46 (February 17-18, 2026)

Feature	Description
Sonnet 4.6	New fast model with full 1M context
Plugin Enhancements	<code>enabledPlugins</code> , <code>extraKnownMarketplaces</code> from CLI
Spinner Tips	<code>spinnerTipsOverride</code> setting
MCP Connector	MCP support for <code>claude.ai</code>

v2.1.47 (February 18, 2026) — Major Stability Release

70+ bug fixes. The quality release.

Category	Fixes
Memory	LSP diagnostic leaks, shell buffer accumulation, WASM interpreter leaks
Files	Trailing blank line preservation, Unicode curly quotes, Windows line endings
Sessions	Title persistence after resume, picker expanded to 50, large message support
Git	Read-only commands no longer trigger FSEvents, custom agents in worktrees
Windows	MSYS2/Cygwin output, bold text shifting, CWD tracking cleanup
UI	Input flicker, CJK alignment, hyperlinks on wrapped lines

v2.1.49 (February 19, 2026) — Worktrees & Background Agents

Feature	Description
<code>--worktree / -w</code>	Isolated git worktrees for parallel development
Background Agents	<code>background: true</code> for fire-and-forget subagents
<code>isolation: worktree</code>	Each subagent gets its own worktree
Ctrl+F	Kill all background agents (two-press confirmation)
Sonnet 4.5 1M Deprecated	Replaced by Sonnet 4.6

v2.1.50 (February 20, 2026) — Worktrees Go First-Class

Feature	Description
WorktreeCreate/Remove Hooks	Automate worktree lifecycle
claude agents	New CLI subcommand to list agents
LSP startupTimeout	Configurable timeout for language servers
1M Context in Fast Mode	Opus 4.6 fast mode now includes full 1M window
Multiple Memory Fixes	Tool results >50KB to disk, completed task cleanup

v2.1.51 (February 24, 2026) — Remote Control Launch

Feature	Description
claude remote-control	Control local sessions from phone/browser
QR Code Access	Scan to connect from mobile
Plugin Registries	Custom npm registries, version pinning
Managed Settings	macOS plist, Windows Registry support
Security	statusLine/fileSuggestion hooks require workspace trust

v2.1.52-56 (February 24-25, 2026)

Rapid stability fixes for Remote Control, worktrees, Windows crashes, VS Code extension.

Phase 5: Scheduling, Memory & Context (March 2026)

v2.1.57-65 (Late February - Early March 2026)

Incremental improvements and stability fixes.

Feature	Description
Auto-Memory	Persistent file-based memory system across conversations
/context Command	Actionable suggestions for optimizing context usage
/color Command	Visually distinguish parallel sessions with colors
Memory Timestamps	Last-modified dates on memory files for freshness reasoning
autoMemoryDirectory	Configurable directory for auto-memory storage

v2.1.66-70 (March 2026) — Scheduling & Effort Control

Feature	Description
/loop Command	Session-scoped recurring task scheduler (cron under the hood)
/effort Command	Set model reasoning effort level per session
Desktop Scheduled Tasks	Persistent tasks in desktop app (survive restarts)
One-Time Reminders	Natural language single-fire reminders
CronCreate/List/Delete	Underlying scheduling tools for /loop

v2.1.71-74 (March 2026) — 1M Context & Fast Mode

Feature	Description
1M Token Context	Default for Opus 4.6 on Max, Team, Enterprise plans
Fast Mode	/fast toggle for faster output (same model, lower latency)
Model Fallback Names	Human-friendly names in fallback notifications
Session Quality Surveys	Enterprise feedbackSurveyRate setting

v2.1.75-76 (March 14, 2026) — MCP Elicitation & Sparse Checkout

Feature	Description
MCP Elicitation	MCP servers can request structured input via interactive dialogs
Elicitation Hooks	Elicitation and ElicitationResult hook events
PostCompact Hook	Fires after context compaction completes
Session Naming	-n / --name CLI flag for display names at startup
Sparse Checkout	worktree.sparsePaths for fast startup in large monorepos
Deferred Tool Fix	ToolSearch tools retain schemas after compaction

Key Milestones at a Glance

Date	Version	Milestone
Nov 2024	—	MCP protocol announced by Anthropic
Feb 2025	v1.0.0	Claude Code preview launch
May 2025	v1.0.0 GA	General availability + Agent SDK
Sept 29, 2025	v2.0.0	VS Code extension + Checkpoints + Thinking mode
Jan 7, 2026	v2.1.0	Skills overhaul + Hooks in frontmatter
Feb 5, 2026	v2.1.x	Agent Teams (research preview)
Feb 17, 2026	v2.1.45	Sonnet 4.6 released
Feb 18, 2026	v2.1.47	Major stability release (70+ fixes)
Feb 19, 2026	v2.1.49	Worktrees + Background agents
Feb 24, 2026	v2.1.51	Remote Control launch
Feb 25, 2026	v2.1.56	Stability fixes
Early Mar 2026	v2.1.6x	Auto-Memory, /context, /color
Mar 2026	v2.1.7x	/loop scheduling, /effort, 1M context default
Mar 14, 2026	v2.1.76	MCP Elicitation, sparse checkout, session naming

Feature Introduction Order

Feb 2025  Core CLI, Permissions, Sessions, CLAUDE.md
Mar 2025  Vim mode, Custom Commands, Thinking, Auto-compact
Apr 2025  Images, @-mentions, Concurrent queries

May 2025 █ MCP Servers, Plugins, Multi-model, SDK
 Sept 2025 █ VS Code, Checkpoints, Subagents (v2.0)
 Jan 2026 █ Skills overhaul, Hooks frontmatter, Teleport (v2.1)
 Feb 2026 █ Agent Teams, Worktrees, Remote Control, Sonnet 4.6
 Mar 2026 █ Memory, /loop, 1M Context, MCP Elicitation, /effort

What Changed Fundamentally at Each Major Version

v1.0 □ v2.0: From Tool to Partner

- **Before:** You tell Claude what to do, step by step
- **After:** Claude works autonomously for hours. Checkpoints let you rewind if it goes wrong. VS Code shows changes in real-time.

v2.0 □ v2.1: From Single Agent to Platform

- **Before:** One Claude instance, one conversation
 - **After:** Multiple agents working in parallel across isolated worktrees. Skills as reusable modules. Hooks for automation. Remote access from any device. Plugin ecosystem for sharing.
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See Also: Feature Deep-Dives

#	Feature	File
01	Session Resume	01-session-resume.md
02	MCP Servers	02-mcp-servers.md
03	Skills & Custom Commands	03-skills-custom-commands.md
04	Hooks System	04-hooks-system.md
05	Plugins	05-plugins.md
06	Agent Teams & Background Agents	06-agent-teams-background-agents.md
07	Worktree Isolation	07-worktree-isolation.md
08	Remote Control	08-remote-control.md
09	Scheduling & /loop	09-scheduling-loop.md
10	Auto-Memory System	10-auto-memory.md
11	Context, Effort & Fast Mode	11-context-effort-fast-mode.md
